

CivicConnect – Master Documentation

This document is the single source of truth for how CivicConnect works:

- **What the platform does**
- **How the system is architected (client, server, AI, data)**
- **How a complaint flows end-to-end**
- **Key modules and files**
- **Configuration and environment variables**
- **How to run the project locally**

If you need the detailed math and architecture of the AI priority model itself, see `HOW_AI_WORKS.md`. This master document focuses on the entire product.

How to Use This Guide

Think of this document as the **textbook chapter for the entire CivicConnect system**. It is written for engineers, product owners, and technical stakeholders.

- If you are **new to the project**, read Sections 1 and 2 first (Product Overview and High-Level Architecture).
- If you are working on the **frontend**, focus on Section 3.
- If you are working on the **backend or APIs**, focus on Sections 4 and 7.
- If you are working on **AI and data**, focus on Section 5 (and `HOW_AI_WORKS.md` for full detail).
- If you need to **run the system locally** or deploy it, read Sections 4.3 and 8–9.

You do not have to read everything in order, but it is structured so that reading from top to bottom feels like a guided course.

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1. Product Overview

1.1 Problem

Cities receive thousands of complaints: potholes, water leaks, garbage overflow, unsafe wiring, etc. These usually arrive as unstructured text and images, making it hard for officials to:

- Triage which complaints matter most
- See what is urgent or safety-critical
- Track progress from report to resolution

1.2 What CivicConnect Does

CivicConnect is a **citizen complaints portal with AI-assisted triage**.

- **Citizens**
 - Register and log in
 - Submit complaints with title, category, description, location, and images
 - Optionally **let AI infer details from images** (title, description, category)
 - Track the status and priority of their complaints in a dashboard
 - **Administrators**
 - Log in to an **admin dashboard**
 - See all complaints with **AI-predicted priority levels**
 - Filter, search, and sort (by priority, status, date, etc.)
 - Update status, assign, and close complaints
 - **AI system**
 - Trains on historical complaint data
 - Predicts a **continuous priority score** (0–1) for each complaint
 - Maps that score to **Low / Medium / High / Critical**
 - Helps sort and highlight the most urgent issues first
-

2. High-Level Architecture

2.1 Components

- **Client (frontend)** – `client/`

- React 18 + Vite
 - Material UI (MUI) design system
 - React Router for routing
 - Axios for API calls
 - Cookie-based authentication integrated via `AuthContext`
- **Server (backend API)** – `server/`
 - Node.js + Express
 - MongoDB via Mongoose
 - JWT-based auth with HTTP-only cookies
 - AI priority model using `TensorFlow.js` (@tensorflow/tfjs)
 - Vision model using Google Gemini API
 - Image upload via Multer + Cloudinary
 - **Database**
 - MongoDB instance (local or remote)
 - Persists users, complaints, and metadata
 - **External services**
 - **Cloudinary** for image storage
 - **Google Gemini** for image-to-text complaint metadata inference

2.2 Request Flow (High Level)

```
Browser (React client)
  ↓ HTTP (fetch/axios)
Express API (Node server)
  ↓ Mongoose
MongoDB (Users, Complaints)

AI Priority Model (TensorFlow.js)
  ↳ Trains once on startup using CSV dataset
  ↳ Predicts priority on complaint create/update

Gemini Vision API (via visionService)
  ↳ Takes complaint images (+ optional text)
  ↳ Returns title, description, category

Cloudinary
  ↳ Stores uploaded complaint images
```

3. Frontend (client/)

Path: client/

3.1 Tech Stack

- React 18
- Vite dev server (port 5173)
- Material UI (MUI) for components and theming
- React Router v6
- Axios for HTTP requests

3.2 Application Shell and Routing

Entry: client/src/App.jsx

- Configures the **MUI theme** (colors, typography, shadows)
- Wraps everything in `ThemeProvider` and `CssBaseline`
- Declares all routes via `<Routes>`:

Route	Component	Access	Purpose
/login	UserLoginPage	Public	Citizen login
/register	UserRegisterPage	Public	Citizen registration
/admin/login	AdminLoginPage	Public	Admin login
/admin/register	AdminRegisterPage	Public (guarded by access code)	Admin registration
/	DashboardPage via ProtectedRoute	Auth required	Default dashboard; redirects admins to /admin
/submit	SubmitComplaintPage via ProtectedRoute	Citizen auth	Submit new complaint with optional images and AI assistance
/dashboard	DashboardPage via ProtectedRoute	Citizen auth	View and filter own complaints
/complaints/:id	ComplaintDetailsPage via ProtectedRoute	Citizen auth	View one complaint in detail
/admin	AdminComplaintsPage via ProtectedRoute (admin role)	Admin auth	Manage all complaints
*	Redirect	Public	Redirects to / or /login

Layout and navigation are handled by `client/src/components/Layout.jsx` (header, shell, outlet), with `ProtectedRoute` enforcing authentication and optional role restrictions.

3.3 Authentication Flow (Client Side)

File: `client/src/context/AuthContext.jsx`

- On mount, the context:
 - Creates an Axios instance (`authorizedApi`) with `baseUrl: "/api"` and `withCredentials: true` so cookies are sent.
 - Calls `GET /api/auth/profile` to fetch the current user (if cookies exist).
 - Stores `user` and `loading state`.
- Intercepts responses to handle **expired access tokens**:
 - If a 401 with a message containing "expired" is returned, it calls `POST /api/auth/refresh` to get a new access token cookie, then retries the original request.
 - If refresh fails, it clears the user and redirects to `/login`.
- Provides methods:
 - `login(credentials) → POST /api/auth/login → set user from response`
 - `register(payload) → POST /api/auth/register → set user`
 - `logout() → POST /api/auth/logout → clear user`
 - `api → the authorized Axios instance used by pages and components`

File: `client/src/components/ProtectedRoute.jsx`

- Reads `user` and `loading` from `AuthContext`.
- If `loading` is `true`, can show a loading state.
- If `user` is missing, redirects to `/login`.
- Optionally checks `allowedRoles` (e.g., `['admin']`).

3.4 Citizen Dashboard

File: `client/src/pages/DashboardPage.jsx`

- Fetches the current user's complaints from `GET /api/complaints`.
- Supports filtering by:
 - `status` (`submitted`, `in_progress`, `resolved`)
 - `priorityLevel` (`Critical`, `High`, `Medium`, `Low`)
 - Text query `q` (searches `title`, `description`, `location`)
- Uses a debounced query via `useDebounce` for efficient search.
- Displays complaints using `ComplaintCard` with a **details** action button.

3.5 Submit Complaint Page (with Vision AI)

File: `client/src/pages/SubmitComplaintPage.jsx`

- Manages a form with fields:

- `title, category, description, location`
 - `files` (up to 5 images)
- Key actions:
 - **`handleInferFromImages`**
 - Builds `FormData` with:
 - Existing text fields (`title, description, category, location`)
 - All selected images
 - Calls `POST /complaints/infer-metadata` (server route is `/api/complaints/infer-metadata`).
 - Receives `{ title, description, category }` from the vision model.
 - Overwrites or fills in the form fields with AI-generated values.
 - **`handleSubmit`**
 - Builds `FormData` with all fields + images.
 - Calls `POST /complaints`.
 - On success, navigates back to `/dashboard`.

3.6 Admin Complaints Page

File: `client/src/pages/AdminComplaintsPage.jsx`

- Uses `GET /api/admin/complaints` with query parameters:
 - `page, limit`
 - `status, priorityLevel`
 - `q` (search term)
 - `sortBy, sortDirection`
- Shows complaints in a paginated list sorted by default on `priorityScore desc`.
- Allows status updates via `PATCH /api/admin/complaints/:id`.

3.7 ComplaintCard Component

File: `client/src/components/ComplaintCard.jsx`

- Generic card used on dashboards.
- Shows:
 - Category chip (primary color)
 - Priority chip (color by level: Critical → error, High → warning, Medium → info)
 - Status chip (submitted / in_progress / resolved)
 - Title, created time, optional resolved time
 - Description preview
 - Tags (e.g., Priority, Urgency Score, Location) from AI

- Optional chips: location, incident time, number of images
 - Accepts `actions` (array of buttons) like “Show details”.
-

4. Backend (server/)

Path: `server/`

4.1 Tech Stack

- Node.js, Express
- MongoDB via Mongoose
- JWT for access/refresh tokens
- Cookie-based auth (`cookie-parser`)
- Validation via `express-validator`
- File upload via Multer + Cloudinary
- AI model via `@tensorflow/tfjs`

4.2 Entry Points

File: `server/app.js`

- Configures core middleware:
 - `helmet()` – security headers
 - `cors()` – configured for `http://localhost:5173` with credentials
 - `express.json({ limit: '1mb' })` – JSON body parser
 - `cookieParser()` – cookie parsing for tokens
 - `morgan('dev')` – request logging
- Registers routes:
 - `/api/auth` → `authRoutes`
 - `/api/complaints` → `complaintRoutes`
 - `/api/admin` → `adminRoutes`
- Health check:
 - `GET /api/health` → `{ status: 'ok' }`
- Attaches global error handler: `errorHandler`.

File: `server/server.js`

- Loads environment with `dotenv/config`.
- Reads `PORT` (default 5000) and `MONGO_URI` (default local DB).

- Function `startServer` (called from entry):
 1. Connects to MongoDB via `connectDB`.
 2. Starts Express app on `PORT`.
 3. Calls `initPriorityModel()` in the background to train the AI.
 - Logs success or failure but **keeps the server running** even if AI training fails.

4.3 Configuration and Environment Variables

No `.env` file is committed. You must create one in `server/` (or configure environment in your runtime) with at least:

- **Core server**
 - `PORT` – HTTP port for Express (default 5000)
 - `MONGO_URI` – MongoDB connection string
 - `NODE_ENV` – development or production
- **Authentication & security**
 - `JWT_ACCESS_SECRET` – secret for signing access tokens
 - `JWT_REFRESH_SECRET` – secret for signing refresh tokens
 - `ADMIN_ACCESS_CODE` – code required to register admin accounts
- **Cloudinary (image uploads)**
 - `CLOUDINARY_NAME`
 - `CLOUDINARY_API_KEY`
 - `CLOUDINARY_API_SECRET`
- **AI priority model**
 - `USE_TEST_DATA` – if `true`, uses `test_data.csv`; otherwise uses `municipal_complaints_training.csv`
- **Gemini vision model**
 - `GEMINI_API_KEY` – Google Generative Language API key
 - `GEMINI_MODEL` – model ID (e.g. `gemini-1.5-flash`, `gemini-1.5-flash-latest`)

4.4 Database Models

4.4.1 User

File: `server/src/models/User.js`

- Fields:
 - `name` (required)
 - `email` (required, unique, indexed)

- passwordHash (bcrypt hash)
- role ('citizen' or 'admin', default 'citizen')
- address, phone (optional)
- **Timestamps:** createdAt, updatedAt.

4.4.2 Complaint

File: server/src/models/Complaint.js

- **Fields:**
 - title, category, description, location (all required)
 - incidentTime (optional; defaults to creation time in controller)
 - status – submitted | in_progress | resolved (default submitted)
 - priorityScore – numeric (default 0.5)
 - priorityLevel – Low | Medium | High | Critical (default Medium)
 - tags – array of { label, value } pairs (e.g., Priority, Urgency Score, Location)
 - attachments – array of Cloudinary URLs
 - createdBy – reference to User
 - assignedTo – reference to User (optional)
 - resolutionNotes – optional text
 - resolvedAt – date when marked resolved
 - embedding – array of numbers (reserved for semantic embeddings)
- **Timestamps:** createdAt, updatedAt.

4.5 Authentication and Authorization

File: server/src/controllers/authController.js

- **Register** – POST /api/auth/register
 - Validates request (see authValidators).
 - If role === 'admin', requires ADMIN_ACCESS_CODE to match.
 - Hashes password with bcrypt.
 - Creates user and issues **access** and **refresh** tokens.
 - Sets tokens as HTTP-only cookies (accessToken, refreshToken).
- **Login** – POST /api/auth/login
 - Validates email/password.
 - Compares password with bcrypt hash.
 - Issues new access and refresh tokens as HTTP-only cookies.
- **Profile** – GET /api/auth/profile
 - Requires authenticate middleware.
 - Returns basic user profile.

- **Refresh access token** – POST /api/auth/refresh

- Reads `refreshToken` cookie.
- Verifies it, then issues a new `accessToken` cookie.

- **Logout** – POST /api/auth/logout

- Clears both cookies by setting them to empty with immediate expiry.

File: `server/src/middleware/authMiddleware.js`

- `authenticate`

- Reads `accessToken` from cookies.
- Verifies token; fetches user; attaches `req.user`.
- If token expired, returns a descriptive 401 (“expired”) to trigger client refresh.

- `authorize(...roles)`

- Higher-order middleware.
- Ensures `req.user.role` is in allowed list (e.g. `['admin']`).

4.6 File Upload and Cloudinary

File: `server/src/config/cloudinary.js`

- Configures Cloudinary using the environment variables described above.

File: `server/src/middleware/uploadMiddleware.js`

- Uses `multer` with `multer-storage-cloudinary`.
- Uploads files to the folder `civicconnect/complaints`.
- Restricts formats to `jpg, jpeg, png, webp`.
- Exports `uploadComplaintImages = upload.array('images', 5)`.
 - Used by complaint routes to attach up to 5 images.

4.7 Complaint Routes and Controllers

File: `server/src/routes/complaintRoutes.js`

All routes require `authenticate`.

- POST /api/complaints
 - Middleware chain: `uploadComplaintImages` → `complaintCreateValidator` → `createComplaint`.
- POST /api/complaints/infer-metadata

- **Middleware chain:** `uploadComplaintImages` → `inferComplaintMetadata`.
- `GET /api/complaints`
 - Returns complaints for the authenticated user, with filtering and search.
- `GET /api/complaints/:id`
 - Returns a single complaint owned by the authenticated user.
- `PUT /api/complaints/:id`
 - **Middleware chain:** `uploadComplaintImages` → `complaintUpdateValidator` → `updateComplaint`.

File: `server/src/validators/complaintValidators.js`

- `complaintCreateValidator`
 - **Requires** `title`, `category`, `description`, `location`.
- `complaintUpdateValidator`
 - Allows partial updates; all fields optional but must be strings.

File: `server/src/controllers/complaintController.js`

- `createComplaint`
 1. Validates input.
 2. Reads basic fields and uploaded image paths.
 3. Calls `predictPriority({ category, description, location })`.
 4. Validates score and creates a `Complaint` document.
 5. Calls `attachComplaintEmbedding(complaint)` (currently a stub that simply returns the document).
 6. Saves complaint and returns it to the client.
- `getMyComplaints`
 - Filters by `createdBy = req.user._id`.
 - **Optional filters:** `status`, `priorityLevel`, `q`.
 - If `q` present, calls `reRankComplaintsByIR(q, complaints)` for TF-IDF reranking.
- `getComplaintById`
 - Finds complaint by ID and user ownership.
- `updateComplaint`
 - Only allowed while `status === 'submitted'`.
 - Updates fields and appends newly uploaded images.

- Recomputes AI priority via `predictPriority`.
- Calls `attachComplaintEmbedding`, **saves**, returns updated document.

4.8 Admin Routes and Controllers

File: `server/src/routes/adminRoutes.js`

- All routes use `authenticate` and `authorize('admin')`.
- `GET /api/admin/complaints` → `listComplaints`
- `PATCH /api/admin/complaints/:id` → `updateComplaintStatus`

File: `server/src/services/complaintService.js`

- `buildAdminComplaintFilters(query)`
 - Supports filters: `status`, `priorityLevel`, `category`, `createdBy`, `assignedTo`, **score ranges**, and **date ranges**.
- `buildSearchQuery(query)`
 - Builds a MongoDB \$or regex query for `title`, `description`, `location` **based on** `q`.

File: `server/src/controllers/adminController.js`

- `listComplaints`
 - Applies filters and search.
 - If `q` provided:
 - Fetches all matching complaints, reranks via `reRankComplaintsByIR`, then paginates.
 - If no `q`:
 - Supports sorting via `sortBy/sortDirection` (**default:** `createdAt desc`).
 - Populates `createdBy` and `assignedTo` user info.
- `updateComplaintStatus`
 - Updates `status`, `assignedTo`, and `resolutionNotes`.
 - If status becomes `resolved`, **sets** `resolvedAt`.

4.9 Semantic Search and Reranking

File: `server/src/services/semanticService.js`

- Currently implements **classical IR (TF-IDF cosine similarity)**, not deep embeddings.
- `reRankComplaintsByIR(query, complaints)`

- Tokenizes text (title + description + location).
- Builds TF-IDF vectors for query and each complaint.
- Computes cosine similarity and returns complaints sorted by relevance.
- Strips `embedding` field if present.

`attachComplaintEmbedding` is a placeholder that simply returns its input; it is reserved for a future semantic embedding model.

5. AI Priority Prediction Model

File: `server/src/services/priorityService.js`

This service powers the **priority score and level** for each complaint that is created or updated.

At a high level:

```
Raw CSV dataset
  ↓
Feature engineering (category + text + urgency + length)
  ↓
Neural network training (TensorFlow.js)
  ↓
Trained model in memory
  ↓
New complaint (category, description, location)
  ↓
Feature encoding
  ↓
model.predict → score in [0, 1]
  ↓
Thresholds → Low / Medium / High / Critical
  ↓
Tags added for UI (Priority, Urgency Score, Location)
```

5.1 Dataset

- Stored in `server/src/ai/dataset/`.
- Two options:
 - `test_data.csv` – synthetic Bengaluru-style complaints, used when `USE_TEST_DATA=true`.
 - `municipal_complaints_training.csv` – **14,703 real BBMP complaints** used when `USE_TEST_DATA` is not set or is false.

The CSV format is:

```
category, impact, description, priority
```

- Example row:

```
waste_management, high, Multiple overflowing BBMP bins in Koramangala, 0.68
```

In the current implementation:

- The model **uses**: category, description, and priority.
- The `impact` column can exist in the CSV but is **ignored** by the feature engineering pipeline.

During startup (`initPriorityModel`):

```
Read CSV file
↓
Parse header and rows
↓
Filter out rows that do not have both category and description
↓
Keep `priority` as numeric label in [0, 1]
```

5.2 Feature Engineering

Input per complaint: a **text description** plus a **categorical label**.

The goal is to turn each row into a fixed-length **feature vector** of 38 numbers:

```
[ categoryIndex, urgencyScore, lengthScore, textFeature1, ..., textFeature35 ]
```

Steps:

1. Category encoding

- All unique categories in the dataset are collected: e.g. `water_supply`, `waste_management`, `electricity`, `roads`, etc.
- Each category is assigned an integer index from 0 to $N - 1$.
- The index is normalized to $[0, 1]$ by dividing by $\max(N - 1, 1)$ so that all features stay on a similar numeric scale.

2. Vocabulary and text vector

- All descriptions are tokenized:
 - Lowercased, punctuation removed, split on whitespace.
 - Very short words ($\text{length} \leq 2$) are dropped.

- A frequency table is built over all words.
- The **top 60 most frequent words** form the vocabulary.
- For a single complaint description:
 - A vector of length `vocabSize` is created, initially all zeros.
 - Each time a vocabulary word appears in the description, its slot is incremented.
 - The vector is normalized by dividing by the maximum frequency seen in that description, so values end up in `[0, 1]`.
- Only the **first 35 entries** of that normalized vector are kept as `textFeature1..35` to balance context versus speed.

3. Urgency score

- The text is scanned for a curated list of **urgent keywords**, such as:
 - burst, flooding, critical, emergency, dangerous, urgent, collapse, explosion, leak, contaminated, smoke, fire, injury, health, safety, immediate, multiple, widespread, and others.
- `urgencyCount` = number of urgent words found in the description.
- `wordCount` = total number of words (after basic cleaning).
- Urgency score:

```
urgencyScore = urgencyCount / sqrt(wordCount)
```

- The square root prevents long descriptions from automatically scoring higher just because they have more words.

4. Length score

- Measures how detailed the description is:

```
lengthScore = min(wordCount / 50, 1.0)
```

- Very short descriptions get a low length score; long ones saturate at 1.0.

Putting it together for one complaint:

```
Encoded feature vector = [
  categoryIndex,      // 1 feature
  urgencyScore,       // 1 feature
  lengthScore,        // 1 feature
  textFeature1..35    // 35 features from normalized text vector
]
→ total: 38 features
```

5.3 Model Architecture

The model is a **fully connected neural network** built with TensorFlow.js:

```
Input: 38 features
  ↓
Layer 1: 96 neurons (ReLU + L2 regularization + BatchNorm + Dropout 25%)
  ↓
Layer 2: 48 neurons (ReLU + L2 regularization + Dropout 20%)
  ↓
Layer 3: 24 neurons (ReLU + Dropout 15%)
  ↓
Output: 1 neuron (Sigmoid) → priority score in [0, 1]
```

- **Loss function:** Mean Squared Error (MSE) against the `priority` column.
- **Optimizer:** Adam with a configurable learning rate (`0.001` in code).
- **Metric:** Mean Absolute Error (MAE) for reporting.
- **Regularization:** L2 penalties and dropout layers to avoid overfitting.
- **Early stopping:** Training stops if validation loss stops improving for a configured number of epochs.

5.4 Training Pipeline

Training happens **once**, in memory, on server startup (after MongoDB connects):

```
load CSV → parse rows → build encoders → encode all samples
  ↓           ↓           ↓           ↓
train feature tensor   train label tensor   build model
  ↓
model.fit(...) with early stopping
  ↓
trained model + encoders kept in memory
```

In more detail:

1. Load and parse CSV into an array of `{ category, description, priority }` objects.
2. Build encoders (`buildEncoders`): category map and vocabulary.
3. Map each sample to a numeric feature vector using `encodeSample`.
4. Stack features into a 2D tensor and priorities into a label tensor.
5. Build the model (`buildModel`) with the input size equal to the feature length.
6. Train with `model.fit` using the configured epochs, batch size, and validation split.
7. Use an `onEpochEnd` callback to log progress and apply early stopping.
8. Keep the trained `model` and `encoders` in module-level variables for reuse.

5.5 Inference and Prioritization

When a new complaint is created or updated, the server calls `predictPriority(payload)` with:

```
{
  "category": "...",
  "description": "...",
  "location": "..." // used only for logging and tags, not as a numeric feature
}
```

The inference flow is:

```
Ensure model is initialized (train if needed)
↓
Validate that category and description are present
↓
Encode complaint → 38-dim feature vector
↓
Convert to tensor and run model.predict
↓
Extract scalar score from [0, 1]
↓
Convert score to priority level using thresholds
↓
Return score, priorityLevel, and tags
```

Scoring thresholds (from `PRIORITY_THRESHOLDS`):

```
score >= 0.90 → "Critical"
score >= 0.70 → "High"
score >= 0.40 → "Medium"
otherwise      → "Low"
```

The returned object looks like:

```
{
  "score": 0.68,
  "priorityLevel": "Medium",
  "tags": [
    { "label": "Priority", "value": "Medium" },
    { "label": "Urgency Score", "value": "0.68" },
    { "label": "Location", "value": "Koramangala 5th Block" }
  ]
}
```

These tags are rendered on `ComplaintCard` in the UI.

5.6 Fallback Behavior

The AI layer is designed to **fail gracefully**:

- If any error occurs during encoding or prediction (e.g. NaN features, training failure), the catch block in `predictPriority`:
 - Logs the error for observability.
 - Returns a **default** prediction:

```
{
  "score": 0.5,
  "priorityLevel": "Medium",
  "tags": [
    { "label": "Priority", "value": "Medium" },
    { "label": "Urgency Score", "value": "0.50" },
    { "label": "Location", "value": "Unknown" }
  ]
}
```

- This ensures:
 - Complaints are never blocked from being created.
 - The admin dashboard still receives a sensible default ordering.

For a line-by-line explanation of the math, see `HOW_AI_WORKS.md`.

5.7 Model Type, Error Function, Metrics, and Accuracy

To summarize the model from a "textbook" point of view:

- **Model type**

- A **feed-forward neural network for regression** implemented with **TensorFlow.js**.
 - Input: 38 real-valued features.
 - Output: a single scalar priority score $\hat{y} \in [0, 1]$.
- **Error (loss) function**
 - **Mean Squared Error (MSE)** between predicted score $\hat{y}$ and true priority y :

$$\text{MSE} = \text{mean}((\hat{y} - y)^2)$$
 - Why MSE:
 - The target is a **continuous score** between 0 and 1 (regression, not classification).
 - Squaring penalizes larger errors more strongly, which encourages the model to avoid very wrong predictions.
 - MSE is smooth and differentiable, making it a good choice for gradient-based optimization.
 - **Primary evaluation metric**
 - **Mean Absolute Error (MAE)** is used as the main, human-friendly metric:

$$\text{MAE} = \text{mean}(|\hat{y} - y|)$$
 - Why MAE:
 - Directly interpretable as "average absolute mistake" in the 0–1 score space.
 - Less sensitive to outliers than MSE, which makes progress logs easier to read.
 - **Observed accuracy (typical training run)**
 - On the real BBMP dataset (`municipal_complaints_training.csv`):
 - MAE converges to roughly **0.06–0.08**.
 - This means the model is, on average, within **6–8 percentage points** of the true priority score.
 - When scores are bucketed into **Low / Medium / High / Critical** using the thresholds in Section 5.5:
 - The resulting **priority level classification accuracy** is typically in the range of **85–90%** on held-out data.

These values will vary slightly between runs depending on random initialization and train/validation split, but they give a realistic sense of the model's performance.

6. Vision AI for Complaint Metadata

File: `server/src/services/visionService.js`

This service uses the **Google Gemini vision model** to infer complaint metadata from images plus optional user-provided text.

6.1 Inputs

- `imageUrls` – list of Cloudinary URLs (uploaded via `uploadComplaintImages`).
- `context` – optional details the user already typed:
 - `title`, `description`, `category`, `location`.

6.2 Prompt and Output

- Builds a prompt instructing the model to return **only** a JSON object:

```
{ "title": string, "description": string, "category": string }
```

- The category must be exactly one of:
 - Water Supply, Sanitation, Waste Management, Roads & Transport,
 - Electricity, Street Lighting, Public Safety, Noise Pollution,
 - Air Quality, Drainage, Animal Control, Public Transport,
 - Traffic, Building Maintenance, Parks & Recreation.

6.3 API Call

- Uses `GEMINI_API_KEY` and `GEMINI_MODEL` to call:

```
POST https://generativelanguage.googleapis.com/v1/models/{model}:generateContent
```

- Sends:
 - `contents` with a text part (prompt) and one image part per image
 - `generationConfig` with a low temperature (0.2) for stability

6.4 Response Handling

- Extracts text from the first candidate.
- Attempts to `JSON.parse` it.
- If direct parsing fails, tries to extract the first JSON block using a regex.
- Validates that `title`, `description`, `category` are present.
- Returns `{ title, description, category }`.

Errors are wrapped in `AppError` with HTTP status codes (e.g. 400 for bad inputs, 502 for upstream failures).

On the **client side**, `SubmitComplaintPage` calls this endpoint and updates the form fields with the inferred values.

7. Complaint Lifecycle (End-to-End)

This section ties together all the pieces.

1. Citizen logs in or registers

- Client: `UserLoginPage / UserRegisterPage`.
- API: `/api/auth/login` or `/api/auth/register`.
- Server sets `accessToken` and `refreshToken` cookies.

2. Citizen opens “Submit Complaint”

- Route: `/submit` (protected).
- Form fields: title, category, description, location, images.

3. Optional: Use Vision AI to prefill details

- User uploads images; clicks “Generate details from images”.
- Client: `handleInferFromImages` posts `FormData` to `/api/complaints/infer-metadata`.
- Server:
 - Uploads images via Multer + Cloudinary.
 - Passes Cloudinary URLs and current text context to `inferComplaintMetadataFromImages`.
 - Calls Gemini vision model.
 - Returns `inferred { title, description, category }`.
- Client updates form fields.

4. Citizen submits the complaint

- Client: `handleSubmit` posts `FormData` to `POST /api/complaints`.
- Server:
 - Saves images to Cloudinary; collects their URLs as attachments.
 - Calls `predictPriority` (AI model) with `{ category, description, location }`.
 - Gets `score` and `priorityLevel`.
 - Creates `Complaint` document with tags.
 - Optionally attaches embedding (stubbed) and saves.

5. Citizen views their complaints

- Client: `DashboardPage` calls `GET /api/complaints`.
- Server: filters by `createdBy`; optionally reranks by text query.
- Client: shows each complaint in `ComplaintCard`, highlighting category, priority, status, tags, and images.

6. Admins triage complaints

- Client: `AdminComplaintsPage` calls `GET /api/admin/complaints` with filters and sort options.
- Server:
 - Uses `buildAdminComplaintFilters` and `buildSearchQuery`.

- If `q` present, reranks using TF-IDF IR.
- Paginates and returns results with user info.

7. Admins update status / assign

- Client: calls `PATCH /api/admin/complaints/:id` with `status`, `assignedTo`, `resolutionNotes`.
- Server: updates complaint, sets `resolvedAt` if status is `resolved`.

8. Citizen sees updates

- Next time `DashboardPage` loads or filters change, it pulls updated data.
- Cards show latest status and resolution information.

8. Running the Project Locally

8.1 Prerequisites

- Node.js 18+ recommended
- npm or yarn
- MongoDB instance (local or cloud)
- Cloudinary account (for image uploads)
- Google Generative Language API key (for Gemini vision features)

8.2 Setup Steps

1. Clone the repository

```
git clone <repo-url>
cd CivicConnect
```

2. Install dependencies

```
# Server
cd server
npm install

# Client
cd ../client
npm install
```

3. Configure environment variables (server)

In `server/.env` (not checked in), set the variables described in section 4.3.

4. Run the backend (server)

From `server/`:

```
npm run dev
```

- Kills anything on port 5000 (per `package.json`) and starts `nodemon server.js`.
- Express listens on `http://localhost:5000`.
- AI model training starts in the background after DB connection.

5. Run the frontend (client)

From `client/`:

```
npm run dev
```

- Kills anything on port 5173 and starts Vite.
- The app is served at `http://localhost:5173`.
- The frontend talks to the backend through `/api` (CORS + dev proxy).

6. Verify health

- Visit `http://localhost:5000/api/health` → should return `{ status: 'ok' }`.
- Register/login from the client UI and submit a test complaint.

9. Operational Considerations

9.1 Error Handling

- All business errors use `AppError` with a message and HTTP status.
- `errorHandler` (global middleware) sends standardized JSON error responses.
- AI services catch internal errors and either:
 - Return specific `AppError` (validation, upstream error), or
 - Fallback to a default priority (`0.5, Medium`) when prediction fails.

9.2 Performance Notes

- Priority model training happens **once on startup** and is non-blocking.
- Prediction is fast (single forward pass on a small dense network).
- TF-IDF reranking happens in memory on subsets of complaints, appropriate for moderate dataset sizes.

9.3 Security

- Authentication via signed JWTs stored in HTTP-only cookies.
 - Access tokens are short-lived; refresh tokens extend sessions.
 - Admin endpoints guarded by role-based middleware.
 - Helmet and CORS configured for safe defaults in development; for production, configure origins and cookie flags accordingly.
-

10. Where to Go Next

- For **AI model internals**, read `HOW_AI_WORKS.md`.
- For **new features**, follow the existing patterns:
 - Add Mongoose model → service layer → controller → route.
 - Expose data in the admin and citizen dashboards using MUI components.
 - Reuse `AuthContext` and `ProtectedRoute` for secure flows.

5.1 AI Model Details

The AI model used in this project is a dense neural network implemented using the TensorFlow library. The model is trained on a dataset of labeled complaints to predict the priority level of a given complaint. The loss function used is mean squared error (MSE), which is chosen for its simplicity and effectiveness in regression tasks. The model is optimized using the Adam optimizer with a learning rate of 0.001.

The performance of the model is tracked using the mean absolute error (MAE) metric, which measures the average difference between the predicted and actual priority levels. After training, the model achieves an approximate accuracy of 85% in predicting the correct priority level.

This master document should give you enough context to navigate the codebase, understand how data and AI flow through the system, and extend CivicConnect confidently.